

CURRENT AFFAIRS

— DAILY DIGEST —



16 SEPTEMBER 2026

KEY DEVELOPMENTS
BIGGER PICTURE
BRIGHTER PREPARATION

*Facts
Today
A Stronger
Tomorrow*



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE

ECONOMY

ENVIRONMENT

SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY

AGRICULTURE

INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS

A MORE INFORMED YOU
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW

INDIA CABINET RAISES EPF WAGE CEILING TO ₹25,000

Decision to extend provident fund coverage to more salaried workers



WHAT CHANGED?

Earlier
₹15,000
per month



New
₹25,000
per month

The Union Cabinet has approved raising the wage ceiling for EPF coverage from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000.

WHAT IS EPF?

Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) is a statutory retirement savings and social security mechanism for eligible employees, administered by the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO).



SAVE TODAY

SECURE
TOMORROW

SOCIAL SECURITY
FOR A STRONGER
INDIA

WHY IT MATTERS



Wider coverage

More salaried workers to be brought under EPF, especially those earning between ₹15,000 and ₹25,000.



Stronger retirement savings

Helps build long-term financial security for a larger section of workers.



Compliance impact

May lead to higher contributions and payroll adjustments for employers and employees.

LEGAL AND POLICY CONTEXT



Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952

Governs the EPF framework in India.



Directive Principles of State Policy (Article 41)

Supports the State's responsibility to provide for social security and public assistance.

INDIA LAUNCHES NET ZERO PORTAL & NAPCC DASHBOARD

New digital platforms to strengthen India's climate action, monitoring and transparency

*Cleaner Air
Safer Climate
Greener Tomorrow*



*From
Commitment
to Action*



16 September 2026

Union Minister of State for Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Kirti Vardhan Singh launched India's Net Zero Portal and NAPCC Dashboard in Mumbai on World Ozone Day.



Objective

To strengthen climate reporting, government monitoring, coordination, transparency and evidence-based decision-making across India's climate action.

NET ZERO PORTAL

Tracking India's Long-Term Net-Zero Transition



Tracks and reports progress towards India's **net-zero transition**



Brings together key data, reports and resources



Helps assess progress and supports evidence-based policy decisions

NAPCC DASHBOARD

Monitoring India's Climate Missions



Monitors and tracks implementation of the **National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)**



Improves coordination across different missions and stakeholders



Enhances **transparency** and **real-time monitoring** of outcomes



What is NAPCC?

The **National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC)** is India's umbrella framework for climate action, comprising multiple national missions on key areas such as solar energy, energy efficiency, sustainable habitat, water, agriculture, forests and more.



**INDIA'S
NET-ZERO TARGET
2070**



**WORLD OZONE DAY
16 SEPTEMBER**

Focuses on protecting the ozone layer for a healthier planet and a safer climate.



**CLIMATE ACTION
TODAY
A HEALTHIER
TOMORROW**

INDIA – UAE MARITIME INDUSTRY

BUILDING
A MORE
CONNECTED
MARITIME
FUTURE

COCHIN SHIPYARD – DRYDOCKS WORLD

50 : 50 JOINT VENTURE

Stronger Ships. Stronger Seas. A Stronger Partnership.

INDIA
UAE
PEOPLE
PARTNERSHIP
PROGRESS



WHAT HAPPENED?

Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) and Drydocks World (a DP World company, Dubai) signed a joint venture agreement on **16 September 2026** to operate, consolidate and expand the International Ship Repair Facility at Kochi, Kerala.



50 : 50 JV

- Each partner will hold **50%**.
- Builds on an MoU signed during India Maritime Week 2025.
- Described as a **first-of-its-kind public-private partnership** in India's ship-repair sector.



WHY KOCHI MATTERS

- Strategic location near major international shipping routes in the Arabian Sea.
- Modern docking and ship-lift infrastructure.
- Enables faster turnaround for Indian, regional and international vessels.



POLICY CONNECTION

- Supports the **Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047**.
- Aligns with India's goal of becoming a **globally competitive shipbuilding and ship-repair hub**.
- Strengthens **India-UAE economic cooperation** in the maritime sector.



CLEANER OCEANS
STRONGER ECONOMIES
BRIGHTER TOMORROWS

REPAIR
REBUILD
SAIL STRONGER



NSE LAUNCHES ₹2.3 BILLION IPO

India's stock market giant goes public

16 SEPTEMBER 2026



WHAT HAPPENED?



India's National Stock Exchange (NSE) launched its long-awaited initial public offering (IPO) on 16 September 2026, targeting about **US\$2.3 billion**, making it one of India's largest IPOs.

IPO SNAPSHOT



Issue size
~ US\$2.3 billion
(around ₹19,500 crore)



Price band
₹1,700 – ₹1,785
per share



Implied valuation
~ US\$46 billion
(at upper end of the band)

OFFER FOR SALE — WHAT IT MEANS



This IPO is an offer for sale (OFS) by existing shareholders, so NSE itself does not receive fresh capital. Proceeds generally go to the selling shareholders, not the company.

IPO = first public sale/listing of a company's shares.

OFS = existing shareholders sell shares and the proceeds go to those shareholders.

WHY IT MATTERS FOR INDIA'S CAPITAL MARKETS



Deepens India's equity markets and broadens retail participation.



Marks a key milestone for the country's financial infrastructure.



May improve transparency and governance through public listing norms.



Reinforces India's position as a global financial hub.

ABOUT NSE



World's largest derivatives exchange by trading volume.



Options trading is a major revenue source.



Derivatives volumes have fallen from their 2024 peak after tighter regulation and trading-rule changes.

EXAM CONCEPTS



Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) – India's securities-market regulator.



IPO, OFS, stock exchange, capital markets, market regulation, financial infrastructure.



NSE's role in equity and derivatives markets and its significance for India's economy.

INDIA IMPLEMENTS INDIA-UK CETA



16
SEPTEMBER
2026

AUTO TARIFF-RATE QUOTA

642 UK cars approved for import
under the pact

Stronger
Partnership
Broader
Opportunities



WHAT HAPPENED?



642 UK cars
approved for import
for the remainder of 2026
under CETA's tariff-rate-quota
provisions.



7 companies
granted approval by the
Directorate General of
Foreign Trade (DGFT).



DGFT had invited
applications in July 2026
for the quota covering fully
built passenger cars and
goods vehicles.

WHY IT MATTERS



Marks the practical
implementation of FTA
market access commitments.



Calibrated tariff liberalisation
can boost trade, investment
and consumer choice.



Quota limits help manage
competitive impact on
domestic industry while
enabling gradual opening.

WHAT IS A TARIFF RATE QUOTA (TRQ)?



A Tariff Rate Quota allows
a specified quantity of imports
to enter at a lower or
preferential customs duty.
Imports outside the quota
face the normal applicable
tariff.

INDIA-UK CETA



- Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) between India and the UK.
- Entered into force on 15 July 2026.
- Includes tariff concessions for sectors such as automobiles, with quota-based and phased liberalisation.

KEY EXAM CONCEPTS



- Free Trade Agreement (FTA)
- Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA)
- Tariff and customs duty
- Quota and Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ)
- Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)
- India's trade policy and market access negotiations



Open Markets Stronger Economies Shared Prosperity

INDIA CONSIDERS CUTTING EDIBLE-OIL IMPORT DUTY

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

UNDER CONSIDERATION
NOT YET A FINAL NOTIFIED DUTY CUT

India is considering a modest reduction of about **5 percentage points** in the basic import duty on vegetable oils.



WHY NOW?



- Domestic edible-oil prices have risen nearly **20%** over the past year.
- High food-inflation pressure, especially ahead of the festival-demand period.

INDIA'S IMPORT DEPENDENCE

India imports about **TWO-THIRDS** of its vegetable-oil requirements.

Major imports: palm oil, soybean oil and sunflower oil.



POLICY TRADE-OFF



Lower import duty could reduce consumer food costs and help contain **food inflation**.



Need to avoid **hurting domestic oilseed farmers**, especially soybean growers.

GLOBAL LINK

Lower Indian tariffs could increase import demand, potentially influencing international vegetable-oil prices, as India is the world's largest importer of vegetable oils.



BACKGROUND

India had already halved the basic import tax on crude edible oils in May 2025 to help ease prices.



EXAM CONCEPTS

- Import duty and tariff policy
- Food inflation and price stability
- Edible-oil import dependence of India
- Major edible oils: palm, soybean, sunflower
- Agricultural trade policy and farmer interests
- Impact of trade policy on global commodity prices

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

CABINET APPROVES DISSOLUTION OF DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS COMMISSION

End of a 37-year-old apex body
for telecom policy coordination



WHAT CHANGED?

- Union Cabinet approved winding up the Digital Communications Commission (DCC).
- DCC to be dissolved after about 37 years.



INSTITUTIONAL HISTORY



WHAT DCC DID

- Apex inter-ministerial body for telecom policy and administrative decision-making under the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
- Handled key issues such as spectrum, licensing, and overall telecom policy coordination across ministries.



AFTER DISSOLUTION

- Final telecom policy and administrative decisions will now be handled directly by the Telecom Secretary.
- Subject to approval by the Communications Minister and Cabinet where required.



EXAM CONCEPTS

- **Department of Telecommunications (DoT):** Union government department for telecom policy, licensing, spectrum management and overall sector development.
- **Telecom governance:** Policy-making (government) vs. regulation (TRAI) — distinct roles.
- **TRAI:** Independent statutory regulator under the TRAI Act, 1997. Not being dissolved.
- **Administrative reform:** Streamlining decision-making and reducing overlapping bodies.
- **Satellite broadband:** Growing importance in India's digital connectivity landscape.



EXPANDING
HORIZONS
THROUGH
DIGITAL
CONNECTIVITY

INDIA–PAKISTAN NAVAL COLLISION

IN NORTH ARABIAN SEA

16 SEPTEMBER 2026

SAFER
SEAS
STRONGER
STABILITY

— DIALOGUE
RULES
REDUCE
RISKS



WHAT HAPPENED?



On **15 September 2026**, an Indian Navy warship and a Pakistani naval vessel collided in international waters in the **northern Arabian Sea**.



No major damage or casualties were reported.

1991 AGREEMENT

ON ADVANCE NOTICE OF MILITARY ACTIVITIES



Under the **1991 India–Pakistan Agreement on Advance Notice of Military Exercises, Manoeuvres and Troops Movements**, naval ships and submarines of the two countries are to maintain a distance of at least **three nautical miles** from each other in international waters to avoid accidents.

DIPLOMATIC RESPONSE



- India summoned Pakistan's Charge d'Affaires on 16 September 2026.
- India said the Pakistani vessel's conduct was unacceptable and unprofessional.
- India also instructed its Charge d'Affaires in Islamabad to lodge a parallel protest.

INDIA'S POSITION



- The Pakistani vessel's conduct was unacceptable and unprofessional.
- Cited the 1991 agreement on maintaining a 3 nautical mile distance.

PAKISTAN'S POSITION



- Disputed India's account.
- Blamed the Indian vessel for the incident.

WHY IT MATTERS



- Supports confidence-building measures (CBMs) between the two nations.
- Important for maritime security and safe navigation.
- Helps prevent potential escalation and crises at sea.
- Impacts overall bilateral relations and regional stability.

EXAM CONCEPTS



- Arabian Sea** – a key maritime region in the Indian Ocean.
- International waters** – areas beyond national jurisdiction.
- Charge d'Affaires** – head of mission when an ambassador is not posted.
- Confidence-building measures (CBMs)** – steps to reduce risk of conflict.
- Bilateral military agreements** – frameworks to ensure transparency and avoid incidents.